

CELERY *Apium graveolens* var. *dulce*

Celery comes in four kinds: self-blanching celery is most common and should be closely planted in blocks, where the plants shade each other enough to blanch their stems. Trench celery is grown in trenches and earthed up as it grows, to give blanched, tender stems that are free from bitterness. Green celery is bred to be succulent without blanching, while some celery is grown as a leafy herb, in the same way as parsley.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Celery plants flower prematurely if planted out too early. To prevent this, planting should be done in early summer from sowings made indoors in mid-spring, as the seed takes a long time to germinate.

Sow seed thinly, barely covering it with soil, in shallow pots or module trays. Seedlings should be grown under cover until they develop a few leaves and their roots fill their pots. Keep them in a moderately warm environment, such as a greenhouse, with plenty of light.

Celery does best in soil that has been enriched with plenty of organic matter and has been supplemented with a balanced fertilizer before planting. Space trench seedlings 12–18 in



Dig up the plants from midsummer.

(30–45 cm) apart in a prepared trench; self-blanching and green types in blocks, spaced 10 in (25 cm) apart. Allow leaf celery 5 in (13 cm) between plants.

CROP CARE

Water seedlings after planting and keep them free of weeds. Water frequently, since tender stems will not form if the plants dry out. Add extra fertilizer if